coursera | MoMA

Seeing Through Photographs ✕

Today's goal • 3/3 items

Module 1
Introduction to Seeing Through Photographs

- ✓ Welcome to Seeing Through Photographs!
  Reading • 3 min
- ✓ Getting Started: How Does This Course Work?
  Reading • 6 min
- ✓ Seeing Through Photographs Course Trailer
  Video • 1 min
- ✓ Sarah Meister Introduces the Course
  Video • 2 min
- ✓ Marvin Heiferman on "Photography Changes Everything"
  Video • 3 min
- ✓ Optional Discussion Forum Prompts
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Optional Readings and Resources
  Reading • 10 min

Module 2
One Subject, Many Perspectives

Part I: Introduction

- ✓ Introduction to Module 1
  Reading • 2 min
- ○ **Artistic Equivalents**
  Reading • 2 min
- ○ Vik Muniz on Photographing the Familiar
  Video • 3 min

Part II: Telescopes and Cameras

- ○ Introduction to Part II: Surface, Scale, and Technology
  Video • 2 min
- ○ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ○ Moons and Surfaces
  Reading • 5 min
- ○ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Eugène Atget. Pendant l'éclipse. 1912
  Video • 3 min
- ○ Hear More: Liz Deschenes on Tilt/Swing (360° field of vision, version 1), 2009
  Video • 1 min
- ○ Surface, Scale, Technology
  Dialogue • 15 min

Part III: Seeing the Unseen

- ○ Introduction to Part III: Man on the Moon
  Video • 2 min
- ○ Photographs by NASA
  Reading • 2 min
- ○ Hear More: Sarah Meister on U.S.G.S. and NASA, Surveyor III. Surface of the Moon, Day 319, III-F. 1967
  Video • 1 min
- ○ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ○ Who Does the Moon Belong To?
  Reading • 4 min

Part IV: It's Only a Paper Moon

- ○ Introduction to Part IV: Vernacular and Fine Art Photographs of the Moon
  Video • 3 min
- ○ Moon Phases
  Reading • 6 min
- ○ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Ansel Adams. Moonrise, Hernandez, New Mexico. 1941
  Video • 3 min
- ○ Man on the Moon and Paper Moons
  Dialogue • 15 min

Part V: Review and Respond

- ○ Optional Readings and Resources
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ Practice Memory Check
  Practice Assignment • 30 min
- ○ Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges
  Reading • 10 min

Module 3
Documents and the Documentary

Module 4
One and Another

Module 5
Constructing Narratives, Challenging Histories

Module 6
Pictures of People

Module 7
Ocean of Images

Artistic Equivalents

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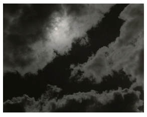
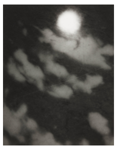
Alfred Stieglitz



Alfred Stieglitz. *Equivalents*. 1923. Gelatin silver print, 3 11/16 × 4 11/16" (9.3 × 11.9 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Alfred Stieglitz Collection. Gift of Georgia O'Keeffe. © 2020 Estate of Alfred Stieglitz/Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York

Photographer and gallerist Alfred Stieglitz demonstrated the expressive potential of photography with his evocative images of clouds. More than portraits of the sky, the photographs are meant to reflect the emotions and states of mind Stieglitz experienced while finding their equivalents in the varied patterns of the clouds. Though the photographs were taken during the day, Stieglitz printed the images very dark, making it difficult to discern whether the clouds are lit by the sun or moon.

Vik Muniz



Vik Muniz. *Equivalents (The Museum of Modern Art)*. 1995. Gelatin silver print, 5 5/16 × 4 3/16" (13.5 × 10.7 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Gift of Gwen and Peter Norton. © 2020 Vik Muniz/Licensed by VAGA, New York, NY

For years, Vik Muniz has recreated images associated with popular culture and art history by playfully—and often elaborately—making arrangements of everyday materials and then photographing them. After seeing Alfred Stieglitz's *Equivalents* in an exhibition at The Museum of Modern Art, Muniz was inspired to make his own version of the series. To simulate Stieglitz's photographs of cloudy skies, he tore a paper circle from the pages of a notebook, placed it on the marble floor that was then in the Museum's lobby, and photographed the makeshift composition.

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